

SCIENCE OF READING REVIEW: CENTRAL BAPTIST COLLEGE

TRADITIONAL

On-Site Review: Date not reported

WHAT'S IN THIS REPORT?

This report uses evidence from an on-site review to examine how an educator preparation program prepares candidates to teach reading using scientific reading instruction, as Arkansas requires of every approved program. It is meant to inform a continuous improvement process that takes educator preparation programs closer to the goals needed to serve Arkansas's students.

The on-site reviews are carried out by Teacher Prep Inspection-US (TPI-US), an external review organization. TPI-US teams inspect coursework and course materials, observe instruction and clinical practice, review program data, and hold focus groups with candidates, faculty, mentor teachers, and school partners. Division of Elementary and Secondary Education staff participate in the review.

TPI-US rates the program in the three review areas of the Arkansas Literacy Review Framework:

- Review Area 1, "Quality of Literacy Coursework," is rated from course materials, syllabi, assignments, and observations of instruction.
- Review Area 2, "Quality of Field-Based Experiences," is rated from placement records, observation and feedback evidence, and focus groups with candidates, mentor teachers, faculty, and school partners.
- Review Area 3, "Quality of Performance Management and Continuous Improvement," is rated from program data systems, quality-control checkpoints, monitoring practice, and partnership evidence.

Every review area receives a rating. Depending on the framework version, the report may also rate each criterion; some earlier reports discuss every criterion without stating a separate rating for it. Performance Levels are defined as follows, in language drawn from the Arkansas Literacy Review Framework:

PERFORMANCE LEVEL	WHAT THE RATING MEANS
4 — EXCEEDS	Coursework and training CONSISTENTLY address the characteristics of high-quality instruction.
3 — MEETS	Coursework and training USUALLY address the characteristics of high-quality instruction.
2 — APPROACHING	Coursework and training INCONSISTENTLY address the characteristics of high-quality instruction.
1 — BELOW	Coursework and training RARELY OR DO NOT address the characteristics of high-quality instruction.

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REVIEW AREA PERFORMANCE LEVELS		
REVIEW AREA 1 LITERACY COURSEWORK	REVIEW AREA 2 FIELD-BASED EXPERIENCES	REVIEW AREA 3 PERFORMANCE MANAGEMENT
MEETS	MEETS	APPROACHING
CRITERIA REVIEWED		
9	11	7
CORRECTIVE ACTION STATUS		
Corrective action plan in place for this review cycle. This program is carrying out a corrective action plan with the Division covering seven actions.		

PROGRAM INFORMATION

INSTITUTION NAME	Central Baptist College
LOCATION	Conway, Arkansas
PROGRAM REVIEWED	Educator preparation program, literacy
PATHWAY	Traditional
REVIEW FRAMEWORK	TPI-US Arkansas SOR Review Framework (2024)
REVIEWING BODY	Teacher Prep Inspection-US (TPI-US)
SITE VISIT DATES	Not reported

REVIEW AREA 1: QUALITY OF LITERACY COURSEWORK

REVIEW AREA 1 PERFORMANCE LEVEL	
MEETS 9 CRITERIA REVIEWED	
CRITERION PERFORMANCE LEVELS	
Overview of the science of reading	Meets
Concepts of print instruction	Meets
Collaborative communication, oral language instruction	Approaching
Phonological and phonemic awareness instruction	Exceeds
Phonics, orthography, automatic word recognition instruction	Exceeds
Fluency instruction	Meets
Vocabulary instruction	Meets
Text comprehension instruction	Meets
Writing instruction	Below
WHAT THE REVIEWERS FOUND	
Reviewers found that EDU 3350 Foundations of Literacy and EDU 4350 Literacy Assessment and Intervention gave candidates a strong foundation in structured literacy, integrating the Simple View of Reading, Scarborough's Reading Rope and Ehri's phases of word reading, with peer teaching, faculty modeling and fieldwork connecting theory to practice. Phonological and phonemic awareness instruction exceeded expectations, with Heggerty-based routines, required articulation of all 44 English phonemes, and administration of the PAST and DIBELS measures. Phonics, orthography and automatic word recognition also exceeded expectations, drawing on Flyleaf decodable texts and Moats' Speech to Print. Reviewers found gaps in oral language, where coursework did not explicitly teach phonology, morphology, syntax, semantics or discourse, and in writing, where the program had no dedicated coursework on encoding, sentence structure or written composition beyond spelling.	
REVIEW RECOMMENDATIONS	
• Strengthen coursework on writing development, covering the stages from emergent to fluent writers and explicit scaffolding for diverse learners • Require candidates to apply writing instruction across subject areas, with strategies for genre-specific writing • Increase opportunities to teach writing in real classrooms through structured fieldwork, peer teaching and faculty modeling • Train candidates to use formative and summative assessment to track student writing progress and to analyze student writing samples • Integrate oral language development explicitly, covering phonology, morphology, semantics, syntax, discourse and orthography • Provide structured opportunities to apply research-backed practices that support language diversity and differentiated instruction	
CORRECTIVE ACTIONS TARGETING THIS AREA	
Three of the seven corrective actions target this review area.	

REVIEW AREA 2: QUALITY OF FIELD-BASED EXPERIENCES

REVIEW AREA 2 PERFORMANCE LEVEL	
MEETS 11 CRITERIA REVIEWED	
CRITERION PERFORMANCE LEVELS	
Selection of clinical placement schools	Meets
Selection of cooperating teachers (mentor teachers)	Meets
Opportunities to observe models of effective early literacy practice	Meets
Field-based placements provide opportunities to use HQIM	Meets
Responsibilities build to candidate readiness for full responsibility	Meets
Opportunities to apply learning about multilingual children	Approaching
Opportunities to apply learning about students who experience difficulty reading	Meets
Mentor teachers are skillful and can coach candidates	Meets
Faculty and supervisors guide and evaluate candidates through training	Approaching
Quality of written and oral feedback	Meets
Student engagement and candidate impact on student learning	Meets
WHAT THE REVIEWERS FOUND	
Reviewers found that the program placed candidates in approved public schools in the Conway, Greenbriar and Pulaski County school districts through a progressive five-level field system integrating observation, lesson planning, evaluation and reflection, with leadership drawing on long-standing relationships with principals and district leaders. Cooperating teachers were selected for demonstrated teaching excellence, appropriate certification and capacity to mentor, though the selection criteria did not explicitly include alignment with structured literacy. Candidates completed the TESS Evidence Classroom Observation Assignment in the Junior Block and TESS Evidence Classroom Visits during the Senior Block internship. Reviewers found most feedback accurate and actionable, but observer and evaluator training inconsistent, with no standardized norming and calibration process, and limited structured field experience with multilingual learners.	
REVIEW RECOMMENDATIONS	
• Define clear mentor selection criteria, provide structured mentor training in science of reading principles, and standardize observer training and assessment calibration • Facilitate hands-on experience implementing strategies for multilingual learners in authentic classrooms or through virtual simulations	
CORRECTIVE ACTIONS TARGETING THIS AREA	
Three of the seven corrective actions target this review area.	

REVIEW AREA 3: QUALITY OF PERFORMANCE MANAGEMENT AND CONTINUOUS IMPROVEMENT

REVIEW AREA 3 PERFORMANCE LEVEL	
APPROACHING 7 CRITERIA REVIEWED	
CRITERION PERFORMANCE LEVELS	
Quality of data the program collects and uses	Meets
Internal quality control gates (or checkpoints) and intervention plans	Meets
Quality of monitoring	Approaching
Monitoring coursework quality, teaching quality, and clinical connections	Meets
Quality improvement planning	Approaching
Partnerships improve candidate experiences with HQIM	Meets
Evaluation of partnerships for readiness to teach early literacy	Below
WHAT THE REVIEWERS FOUND	
Reviewers found that the program gathered data through seven key assessments, including Praxis scores, teacher work samples, unit plans, micro-teaching assessments, final clinical evaluations, structured observation feedback, and mentor and supervisor ratings, supplemented by exams, grades, course surveys, employer feedback and annual reviews. The reestablished Teacher Education Advisory Board met twice a year to review assessment trends. Quality control gates followed a five-level progression system with professional growth plans, a counseling-out process and an alert system for candidates who had not met benchmarks. Reviewers found that monitoring lacked clear, measurable goals and systematic tracking, that coursework adjustments and faculty training were not consistently aligned with assessment trends, and that no formalized process existed for evaluating whether partnerships prepared candidates to teach literacy.	
REVIEW RECOMMENDATIONS	
• Develop structured feedback loops so survey, assessment and employer data inform program improvement, and survey cooperating and mentor teachers regularly • Ensure the Teacher Education Advisory Board meets consistently and develop a formalized system for tracking the impact of programmatic changes	
CORRECTIVE ACTIONS TARGETING THIS AREA	
Three of the seven corrective actions target this review area.	

CORRECTIVE ACTION PLAN

Where a review identifies findings that require follow-up, the program develops a corrective action plan with the Division of Elementary and Secondary Education. The recommendations under each review area above are the reviewers' advice; the plan below is the program's formal response, monitored by the Division. Actions are grouped by the review area whose findings prompted them.

TOTAL ACTIONS	HIGH PRIORITY	MEDIUM PRIORITY	LOW PRIORITY
7	3	3	1

The plan sets out 7 corrective actions: 3 high priority, 3 medium priority and 1 low priority. The priorities are the plan's own. Some actions target more than one review area, so the per-area counts shown under each review area add to more than the total.

ACTIONS THE PROGRAM IS TAKING

PRIORITY	ACTION	FINDING THAT REQUIRED IT	SUCCESS METRICS
HIGH RA1	Build a program-wide writing strand across K-6 and the content areas	RA1: Writing instruction below expectations; limited encoding to sentence to composition progression	At least 85% of candidates proficient on the writing rubric; at least 2 coached writing lessons per candidate; improved P12 writing samples
HIGH RA1	Integrate oral language structures and interventions	RA1: Oral language instruction approaching; limited explicit structures and assessments	At least 85% of candidates meet the oral language rubric; all complete one intervention cycle with reflection
HIGH RA2, RA3	Observer training, norming and calibration	RA2 and RA3: Inconsistent observer training; need reliable feedback	Inter-rater agreement of at least 0.80; 100% of observers certified; candidate survey at least 4 out of 5 on feedback usefulness
MEDIUM RA2	Strengthen multilingual learner practice	RA2: Limited multilingual placements; few simulations; limited syntax and cognate supports	At least 1 multilingual placement or simulation for 100% of candidates; lesson plans include language objectives
MEDIUM RA2, RA3	Partnership memoranda of understanding and mentor selection criteria	RA2 and RA3: Need formal mentor criteria; partnership evaluation below expectations	100% of memoranda of understanding include the criteria; at least 90% of mentors trained; partner scorecard shows at least 3 out of 4
MEDIUM RA3	Formal monitoring and continuous improvement cycle	RA3: Monitoring and planning approaching; need goals and dashboards	Dashboard live; Teacher Education Advisory Board meets twice a year; at least 80% of action items completed; outcome gains on key performance indicators

PRIORITY	ACTION	FINDING THAT REQUIRED IT	SUCCESS METRICS
LOW RA1	Fluency progressions and background knowledge activation	RA1: Fluency scaffolds can deepen; need schema activation in comprehension	At least 80% of candidates proficient on the fluency and comprehension planning rubrics

OVERSIGHT

Each action in the plan carries an evidence requirement and a framework criterion it answers to. The program supplies the responsible owner and the completion timeline for each action when it returns the plan to the Division. Those owner and timeline entries are left blank in the plan as issued and are therefore not published here.

Sources: TPI-US Written Report & Recommendations, Central Baptist College, conducted under the TPI-US Arkansas SOR Review Framework (2024). Central Baptist College Science of Reading Corrective Action Plan (2025-2026), Arkansas DESE. Rating scale language quoted from the Arkansas Literacy Review Framework.